MindForm Studio — UI/UX Case Study

A Branding & Minimalist Design System Project by Vanshi Shah

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01 — Project Overview

Role: UI/UX Designer, Visual Designer
Tools: Figma, Photoshop (basic touch-ups)
Project Type: Personal Project (End-to-end Design System + Branding)
Timeline: 1–2 weeks (iterative updates)

Goal:
To create a premium, minimal, and future-ready visual identity system under the name **Mindform Studio**, focusing on strong visual hierarchy, clean layout principles, and brand consistency. This project demonstrates my ability to handle UI foundations, branding, typography systems, and iconography with a professional workflow.

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02 — Problem Statement

Many beginner design portfolios show scattered work without a cohesive identity. I wanted to challenge myself to create a unified, luxury-style brand system using consistent rules, spacing, and typography — the same principles required in real UI/UX work.

Core Problem to Solve:
How can I build a design system that looks premium, minimal, and structured while showcasing my evolving UI/UX skills?

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03 — Objective & Approach

Project Objective

To build a brand identity that reflects:

- Clean & minimal design direction
- Strong layout systems
- Professional use of grids
- Modern typography pairing
- A polished designer-level aesthetic

My Approach

1. Define a clear **visual tone** (luxury minimal + subtle glow).
2. Develop a **color palette** for brand identity.
3. Create a **logo system** (symbol + wordmark + tagline).
4. Build UI-friendly rules: spacing, grid, typography scales.
5. Refine through iterations (e.g., reducing glow, font adjustments).

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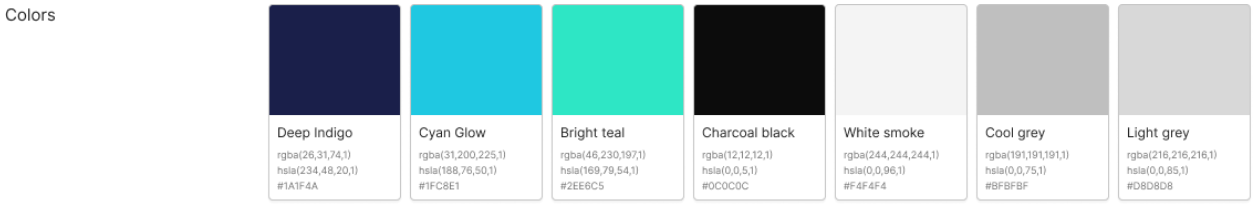
04 — Brand Foundations

Color Palette (Finalized)

- Deep Indigo — #1A1F4A (Primary identity color)
- Cyan Glow — #1FC8E1 (Accent)
- Bright Teal — #2EE6C5 (Secondary accent)
- Charcoal Black — #0C0C0C
- White Smoke — #F4F4F4
- Cool Gray — #BFBFBF
- Light Gray — #D8D8D8
- Supporting red/purple accents for icons when needed

These colors were chosen to maintain a luxurious, premium feel while still offering contrast and flexibility for UI.



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05 — Logo Development

Concept:

The symbol was designed to feel modern, sharp, and geometric. Initially, the glow was strong — but following refinement, it was made subtle to align with the minimal brand direction.

Typography:

- Final symbol typeface: **Freebooter Script Regular** (for an elegant, signature-like mark)
- Wordmark + Tagline: Clean, modern sans-serif with 8pt grid alignment

Key Iterations:

- Version 1: Strong glow, heavier form
- Version 2: Reduced glow, refined angles
- Version 3: Typography update + perfect 8pt grid alignment

These iterations show adaptability and willingness to refine based on feedback (a crucial UX skill).

Final Version:

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06 — UI Design System Elements

Instead of building random screens, I created structured components to demonstrate UI/UX thinking.

Components Created:

- Logo variations (symbol-only, wordmark, vertical lockup)
- Button styles (primary, ghost, minimal)
- Icon style guidelines (stroke width, corner rounding)
- Typography scale (Headline, Subhead, Body, Caption)
- Spacing system (based on 8pt methodology)
- Brand mockups for UI use

These components can be applied to websites, dashboards, or mobile apps.
Here are the Prototype of a Mobile App:

https://www.figma.com/proto/Lpke5TJED9tQBVta8jr1Pb/app?node-id=0-1&t=eB9UFwQcZxR7HK1C-1

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07 — Visual Language & Rationale

Design Principles Followed:

- **Minimalism:** Avoid clutter, rely on strong spacing.
- **Hierarchy:** Larger headings + subtle body text for balance.
- **Contrast:** Accent colors sparingly for focus points.
- **Consistency:** Uniform grid-based rules across assets.
- **Scalability:** A system that can grow into app UI or website UI effortlessly.

Why This Matters for UX:

While this is a brand project, the skills overlap directly with UI/UX foundation work:

- Creating scalable systems
- Maintaining consistency

- Understanding spacing and grid
- Designing reusable components
- Using visual hierarchy intentionally

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08 — Final Outcome

Mindform Studio is one of my most refined and complete projects.

Project Achievements:

✓ Developed a polished brand identity from scratch
✓ Created a scalable UI-friendly design system
✓ Showcased adaptability through multiple design refinements
✓ Maintained professional grid, spacing, and typography rules
✓ Demonstrated strong understanding of minimal and modern design

What this project shows about me:

- I can work with feedback and iteration
- I understand design systems, not just aesthetics
- I can create structure, hierarchy, and consistency
- My visual design skills are polished and professional
- I can deliver high-quality output independently

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09 — Learnings & Next Steps

Key Learnings:

- Simplicity is powerful when paired with structure
- Subtle adjustments (glow, spacing, type) create major improvements
- Working with constraints (8pt grid, limited palette) improves consistency

Next Steps:

- Expand Mindform
- Add more interaction prototypes later

- Package assets into a downloadable design system

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10 — Final Note

This project represents my **best work** so far — a demonstration of creativity, technical skill, and professional design discipline. It’s more than a logo project; it’s a full identity and UI foundation system that reflects real UI/UX principles.